

Lab: Coordination Mechanism Design

Objectives

Learning Goal: Analyze your team's coordination mechanisms, identify mismatches with task requirements, and redesign for effectiveness.

Part 1: Task Interdependence Analysis (10 min)

Classify your team's key workflows by interdependence level:

Workflow	Interdependence Level	Current Coordination Mechanism	Match?
	Parallel/Sequential/Reciprocal/ Intensive		Y/N

Write your response here

Part 2: Coordination Overhead Audit (10 min)

Activity	Hours/Week	Purpose	Could Be Eliminated/Reduced?
Meeting 1			
Meeting 2			
Status reporting			
Email coordination			
Ad-hoc check-ins			
Total			

What fraction of total work time is spent on coordination? Is this appropriate?

Write your response here

Part 3: Implicit vs. Explicit Coordination (10 min)

Scenario	Does the team coordinate implicitly (without discussion) or explicitly (through communication)?	Evidence
When a deadline is at risk		
When requirements change		
When a team member is absent		
When priorities conflict		

Write your response here

Part 4: Redesign Proposal (20 min)

Based on your analysis, propose changes:

1. **Add:** A coordination mechanism that's missing

Write your response here

1. **Remove:** A coordination mechanism that's wasteful

Write your response here

1. **Modify:** A mechanism that needs adjustment

Write your response here

Summary

Finding	Detail
Coordination overhead (% of time)	
Biggest mismatch (mechanism vs. task)	
Most effective coordination tool	
Priority change	